

Make a plan that can change

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

A useful plan identifies a target, a method, and a reason the position supports it. It should be revised when the opponent changes the structure or creates a forcing threat. Consistency is valuable only while the underlying conditions remain.

WORKED EXAMPLE

You plan a queenside minority attack to create a weak pawn. The opponent opens the center against your uncastled king. Continuing the pawn march without addressing the center ignores the changed position.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should cause you to revise a plan?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A new forcing threat, a changed pawn structure, an exchange of a key piece, or loss of access to the target. Re-evaluate the reason for the plan rather than mechanically following its next move.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Keep the objective flexible and the calculation concrete.